

FOTD # 008

The Printer Has Opinions

CATEGORY	Steganography, Cryptography
DIFFICULTY	Medium
DATE	24/09/2026
FLAG FORMAT	INFOSEC_SIG{...}

DESCRIPTION

The office printer has printed something it wasn't supposed to. It left behind a strange diagnostic sequence, a maintenance manual, and a photograph from the service desk. The printer claims everything is normal. The printer is probably lying. Figure out what it is trying to say.

DIAGNOSTIC SEQUENCE

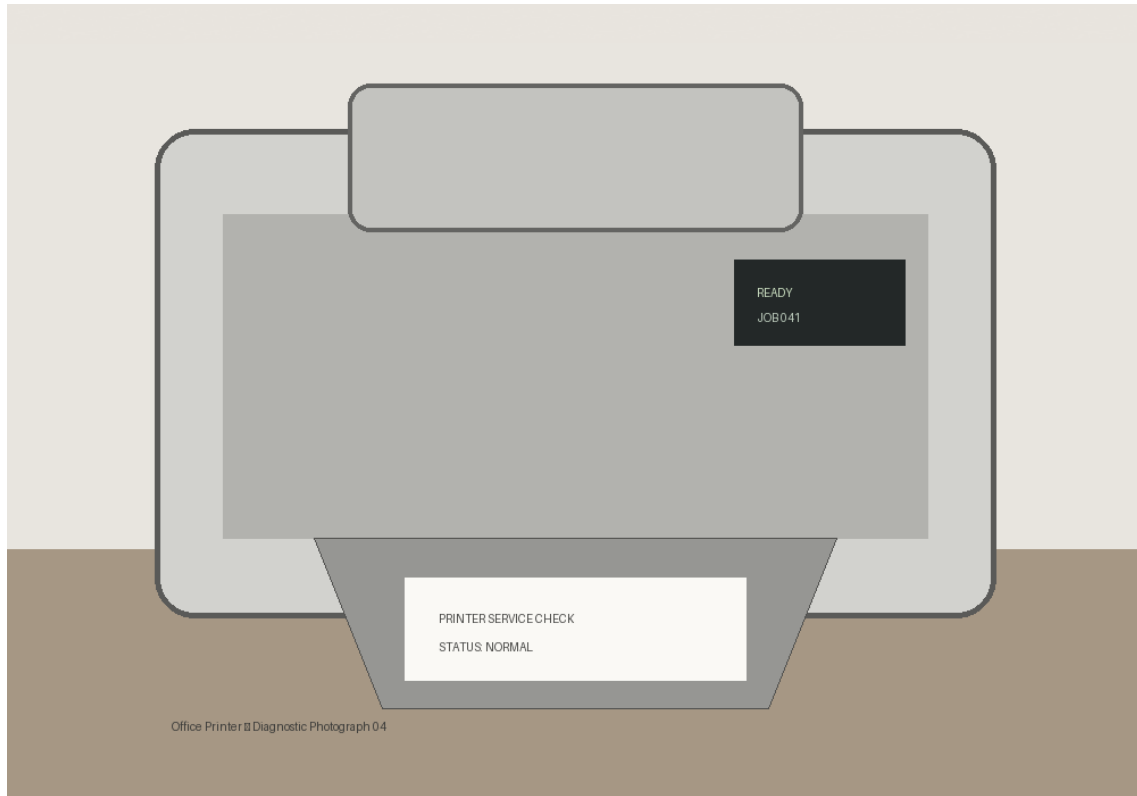
1-1-4 / 2-3-5 / 1-2-1 / 1-2-9 / 1-1-9 / 1-1-8 / 1-1-3 / 1-3-7 / 1-2-3 / 1-4-11 / 1-1-2 / 1-2-2
/ 1-3-1 / 3-4-1 / 1-1-1 / 2-3-1 / 1-2-6 / 1-3-9 / 1-2-5 / 1-3-8 / 2-1-7 / 1-1-5 / 1-4-4 / 4-2-8
/ 2-1-1 / 2-3-7 / 4-3-3 / 1-4-1

A copy of the printer's maintenance manual is included on the following pages. The photograph looks like an ordinary service snapshot.

HINTS

- The printer left behind more than just paper.
- A picture can contain more than what you see.
- Try looking at the image, not just looking at the image.

SERVICE PHOTO



FLAG FORMAT CAUTION: Format your final submission in the usual `INFOSEC_SIG{ . . . }` form.
Talk is cheap, Send flags.

PRINTER MAINTENANCE MANUAL

Paragraph 1

The printer checks its paper path before every scheduled maintenance cycle.

Fresh rollers improve feeding and reduce the chance of uneven pages.

Inspect the tray carefully when a sheet stops halfway through the machine.

Small scraps can interfere with sensors and should be removed gently.

Paragraph 2

Internal surfaces should remain clean so ordinary jobs finish without marks.

Good maintenance keeps the machine reliable during busy working hours.

Engineers usually record unusual noises before opening the rear panel.

Each inspection should end with a short test print for confirmation.

Paragraph 3

Paper dust collects around moving parts after repeated use.

Routine cleaning prevents residue from affecting the feed mechanism.

Inspect the guides whenever pages begin entering at an angle.

Never force a jammed sheet because torn paper can hide inside the rollers.

Paragraph 4

Regular checks help identify worn components before they cause delays.

Keep replacement rollers sealed until they are needed.

Every service note should mention the date and the work completed.

Replacing a damaged pad is usually simpler than repairing a larger feed problem.

Paragraph 5

Always switch the printer off before cleaning internal parts.

Use a soft cloth when wiping accessible surfaces.

Power should be restored only after the covers are securely closed.

Operators can then run a test page and check the printed result.

Paragraph 6

Printer firmware should be updated according to the manufacturer's schedule.

Network settings are normally checked separately from mechanical maintenance.

Keep configuration records somewhere that authorised staff can find them.

Good records make repeated faults easier to investigate.

Paragraph 7

Paper should be stored in a dry place away from direct sunlight.

Humidity can change how sheets move through the feed path.

Keep opened packets closed when the printer is not being used.

Clean storage reduces dust and helps maintain consistent printing.

Paragraph 8

Before finishing a service visit, check that every panel is secure.

Listen for unusual sounds during the final test cycle.

Print a simple page to confirm that alignment remains correct.

Normal operation after maintenance is the clearest sign that the job is complete.